

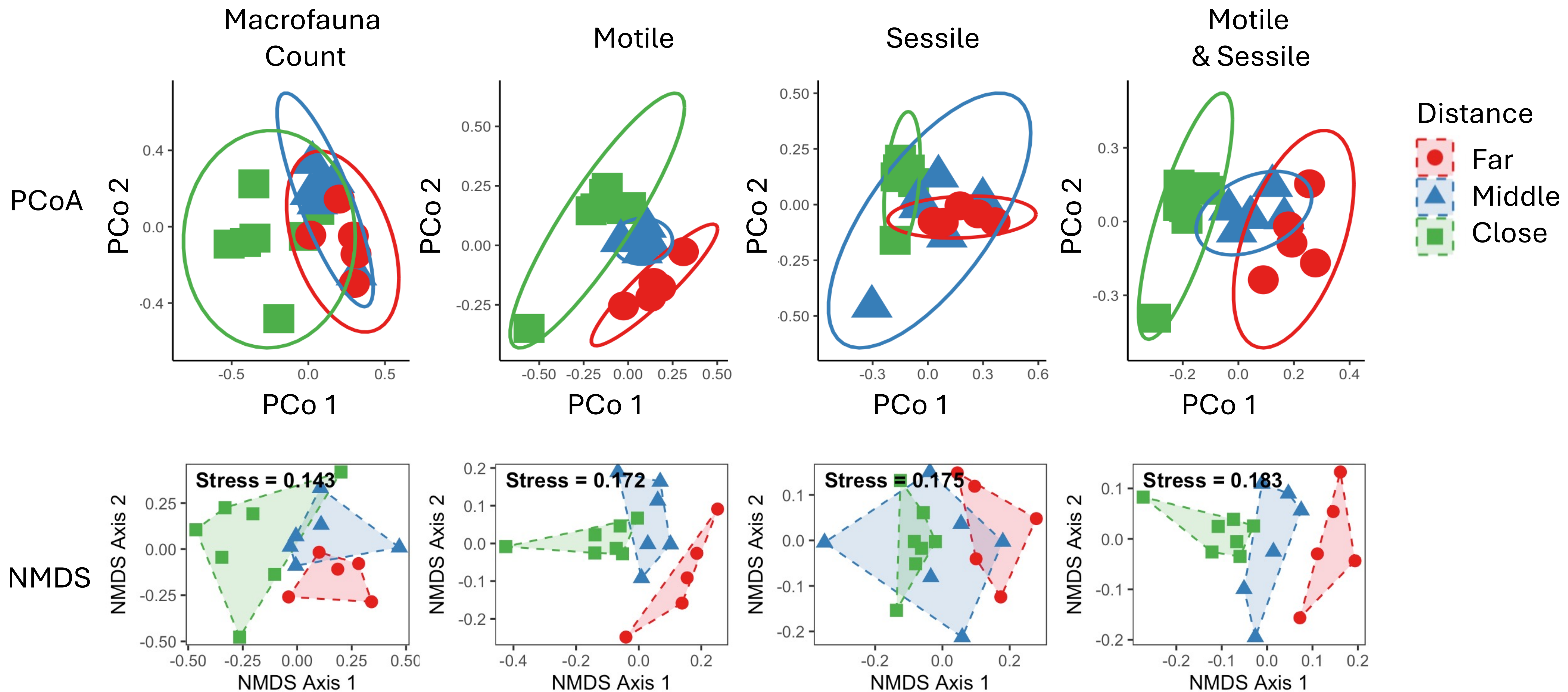


Figure 3: Metric (Principal Coordinates Analysis, PCoA) and non-metric (Non-metric Multidimensional Scaling, NMDS) ordinations of community composition across four datasets: macrofauna counts, motile metabarcoding, sessile metabarcoding, and combined motile and sessile metabarcoding. Points represent individual ARMS communities, color-coded by distance from the established reef. Ellipses (PCoA) represent 90% confidence intervals around the centroid of each distance group. Dashed convex hulls (NMDS) enclose all points belonging to each distance group, illustrating the extent of community dispersion. Across all datasets, close (green) and far (red) communities formed distinct clusters with minimal overlap, while middle (blue) communities occupied an intermediate position, overlapping with both adjacent groups.